Chico's Housing Crisis ... A Path Forward

CITY COUNCIL PUBLIC COMMENT | OCTOBER 20, 2026 | APPROX. 3 MINUTES

Good evening, Mayor Reynolds and members of the Council. My name is Scotty Franzyshen.

I've submitted my full written statement for your review.

We may disagree about policies, but surely we all want safe streets, fewer people experiencing homelessness, affordable housing, and neighbors treated with dignity.

These aren't liberal or conservative goals. They're community goals.

But accountability matters. We cannot learn from our past decisions unless we're willing to examine them.

Over the past two housing cycles, Chico met just **18%** and **30%** of its low-income housing goals. Yet in the last cycle, we managed to achieve **over 200%** of our higher-income housing goal!

We've spent millions on emergency shelter. How many people have reached permanent housing?

Have we built a system that is better at managing homelessness than ending it?

Permanent affordable housing takes time. People need somewhere safe to go **now**.

North State Shelter Team has proposed tiny homes for vulnerable women. Why aren't we doing more to support alternatives like these?

A Personal Challenge to the Council

And I have a personal challenge for every member of this Council:

SPEND ONE FULL NIGHT AT THE TORRES SHELTER!

Not a guided tour. Not a photo opportunity. Arrange a genuine overnight experience without taking a bed away from someone who needs it.

Experience the crowded sleeping quarters, restrictions, lack of privacy, and reality of having so little control over your environment.

I've experienced those conditions myself.

Then come back and tell the people of Chico what you learned.

If you're going to make decisions about how people must live, shouldn't you be willing to experience those conditions yourself?

Yet we're considering expanded enforcement against people with nowhere appropriate to go.

When a shelter says no, where are they supposed to sleep?

Citations, arrests, and encampment removals do not create affordable housing.

We cannot solve a housing shortage by punishing the people experiencing its consequences.

This isn't about blame. It's about accountability ... and cooperation.

Let's move from blame to belonging.

Let's find that common ground ... and get to work.